

# BEE 4750 Lab 2: Monte Carlo

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**Due Date**

Thursday, 10/02/25, 9:00pm

## Setup

The following code should go at the top of most Julia scripts; it will load the local package environment and install any needed packages. You will see this often and shouldn't need to touch it.

```
import Pkg
Pkg.activate(".")
Pkg.instantiate()
```

Activating project at `~/lab-2-cpj35-design`

```
using Random # random number generation
using Distributions # probability distributions and interface
using Statistics # basic statistical functions, including mean
using Plots # plotting
```

## Overview

In this lab, we will conduct a Monte Carlo experiment and explore how sensitive Monte Carlo estimates are to the underlying probability distribution(s).

You should always start any computing with random numbers by setting a “seed,” which controls the sequence of numbers which are generated (since these are not *really* random, just “pseudorandom”). In Julia, we do this with the `Random.seed!()` function.

```
Random.seed!(1)
```

`TaskLocalRNG()`

It doesn't matter what seed you set, though different seeds might result in slightly different values. But setting a seed means every time your notebook is run, the answer will be the same.

### Seeds and Reproducing Solutions

If you don't re-run your code in the same order or if you re-run the same cell repeatedly, you will not get the same solution. If you're working on a specific problem, you might want to re-use `Random.seed()` near any block of code you want to re-evaluate repeatedly.

## Probability Distributions and Julia

Julia provides a common interface for probability distributions with the [Distributions.jl package](#). The basic workflow for sampling from a distribution is:

1. Set up the distribution. The specific syntax depends on the distribution and what parameters are required, but the general call is the similar. For a normal distribution or a uniform distribution, the syntax is

```
# you don't have to name this "normal_distribution"
#  is the mean and  is the standard deviation
normal_distribution = Normal( , )
# a is the upper bound and b is the lower bound; these can be set to +Inf or -Inf for an
uniform_distribution = Uniform(a, b)
```

There are lots of both [univariate](#) and [multivariate](#) distributions, as well as the ability to create your own, but we won't do anything too exotic here.

2. Draw samples. This uses the `rand()` command (which, when used without a distribution, just samples uniformly from the interval  $[0, 1]$ .) For example, to sample from our normal distribution above:

```
# draw n samples
rand(normal_distribution, n)
```

Putting this together, let's say that we wanted to simulate 100 six-sided dice rolls. We could use a [Discrete Uniform distribution](#).

```
dice_dist = DiscreteUniform(1, 6) # can generate any integer between 1 and 6
dice_rolls = rand(dice_dist, 100) # simulate rolls
```

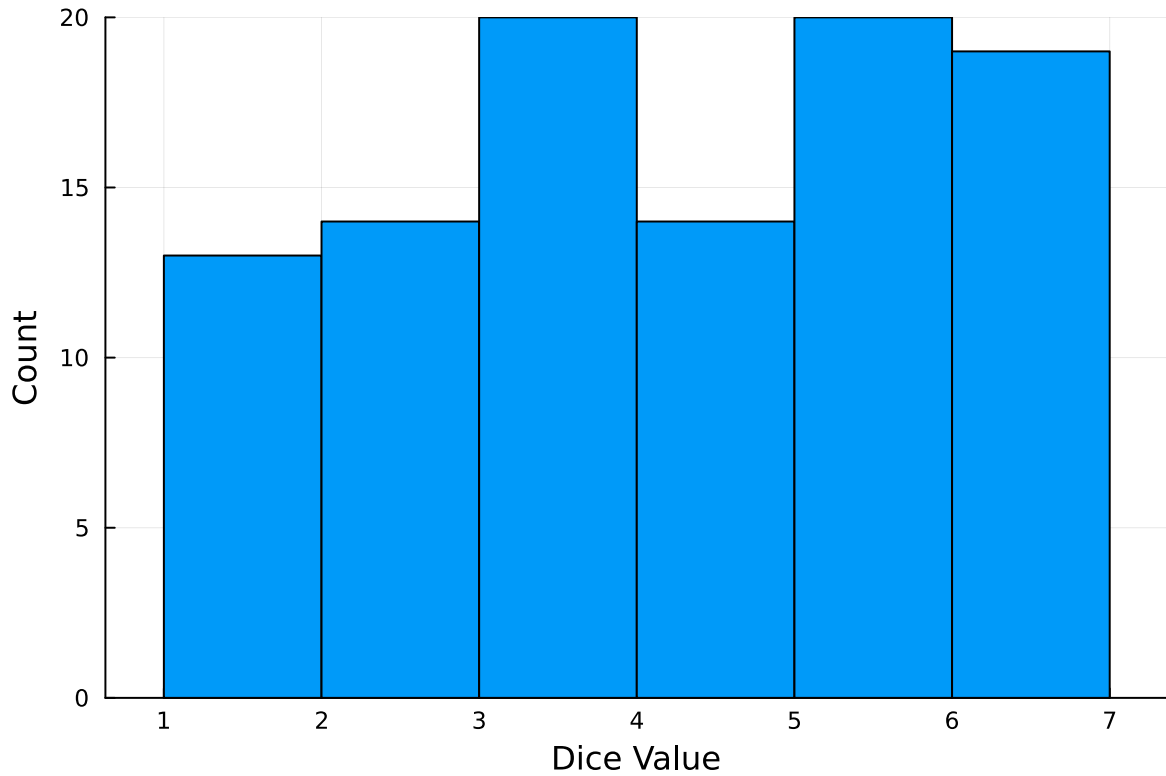
100-element Vector{Int64}:

```
1
3
5
4
6
2
5
5
5
2

3
6
5
5
6
3
6
6
6
```

And then we can plot a histogram of these rolls:

```
histogram(dice_rolls, legend=:false, bins=6)
ylabel!("Count")
xlabel!("Dice Value")
```



### Instructions

#### Remember to:

- Evaluate all of your code cells, in order (using a `Run All` command). This will make sure all output is visible and that the code cells were evaluated in the correct order.
- Tag each of the problems when you submit to Gradescope; a 10% penalty will be deducted if this is not done.

### Problem

A common engineering problem is to quantify flood risk, which is typically computed by propagating a flood hazard distribution through a *depth-damage function* relating flood depths to economic damages. A reasonable depth-damage function for a house without a basement is a bounded logistic function,

$$d(h) = \mathbb{1}_{h>0} \frac{L}{1 + \exp(-k(h - h_0))},$$

where  $d$  is the damage as a percent of total structure value,  $h$  is the water depth (relative to the house's ground floor elevation) in m,  $\mathbb{1}_{x>0}$  is the indicator function,  $L$  is the maximum loss in USD,  $k$  is the slope of the depth-damage relationship, and  $h_0$  is the inflection point. We'll assume  $L = \$200,000$ ,  $k = 0.8$ , and  $h_0 = 3$ .

For this problem, suppose that we have two different probability distributions characterizing annual maxima flood depths:

1.  $h \sim \text{LogNormal}(1.2, 0.3)$ ;
2.  $h \sim \text{GeneralizedExtremeValue}(3, 0.9, -0.15)$ .

Plot histograms of samples from these distributions and conduct a Monte Carlo experiment for annual maximum flood damages using each. Answer the following questions:

- What are the Monte Carlo estimates of the expected value and the 99% quantile for the annual maximum damage the structure would suffer for each of these flood hazard distributions?
- How did you decide on your sample size?
- Why do you think the estimates differed or did not differ (you can also plot the depth-damage function to compare with the samples)?
- How might you decide (based on getting additional information, if needed) which distribution is “better”?

```
L=200,000
k=0.8
h_0=3
sample_size=200

function damage_log(n)
    damage_vals1 = zeros(n)
    for i in n
        h1=LogNormal(1.2,0.3)
        damage_vals1[i] = h1*L/(1+(exp(-k*(h1-h0))))
    end
    return damage_vals1
end

function damage_xtreme(n)
    damage_vals2 = zeros(n)
    for i in n
        h2=GeneralizedExtremeValue(3,0.9,-0.15)
        damage_vals2[i] = h2*L/(1+(exp(-k*(h2-h0))))
    end
    return damage_vals2
end
```

```

end

damage_log = function damage_log(sample_size)
damage_xtreme = function damage_xtreme(sample_size)

histogram(damage_vals1, legend=:false, bins=6)
histogram(damage_vals2, legend=:false, bins=6)

```

Base.Meta.ParseError: ParseError:

# Error @ /Users/clairejacobson/lab-2-cpj35-design/jl\_notebook\_cell\_df34fa98e69747e1a8f8a730347b8e2f\_X16sZmlsZQ==.jl:1:

histogram(damage\_vals1, legend=:false, bins=6)

histogram(damage\_vals2, legend=:false, bins=6)

#

Expected `end`

ParseError:

# Error @ /Users/clairejacobson/lab-2-cpj35-design/jl\_notebook\_cell\_df34fa98e69747e1a8f8a730347b8e2f\_X16sZmlsZQ==.jl:1:

histogram(damage\_vals1, legend=:false, bins=6)

histogram(damage\_vals2, legend=:false, bins=6)

#

Expected `end`

Stacktrace:

[1] top-level scope

@ ~/lab-2-cpj35-design/jl\_notebook\_cell\_df34fa98e69747e1a8f8a730347b8e2f\_X16sZmlsZQ==.jl:1:

## References

Put any consulted sources here, including classmates you worked with/who helped you.